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MAGNETIC DISK APPARATUS

Abstract

According to one embodiment, a disk apparatus includes plural magnetic disks, a spindle motor that rotates the plural magnetic disks, and a housing. The housing has a bottom wall to which the spindle motor is attached and a side wall molded integrally with the bottom wall. Further, the disk apparatus includes a first board attached to the side wall and a first connector attached to the first board for connection with an external device. The first connector has a housing portion with a first surface at least partially facing the bottom wall and a second surface crossing the first surface and a contact portion provided in contact with at least one of the first surface and the second surface, and the contact portion has one end for electric connection with the external device and the other end provided immediately below the first connector.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S)

[0001] This application is based upon and claims the benefit of priority from Japanese Patent Application No. 2024-032608, filed Mar. 5, 2024, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

[0002] Embodiments described herein relate generally to a magnetic disk apparatus.

BACKGROUND

[0003] In a disk apparatus such as a hard disk drive (HDD), electronic components such as plural magnetic disks, a spindle motor (SPM), and a head assembly are housed in a housing. On the bottom surface of the housing, the electronic components housed in the housing and a printed circuit board (PCB) electrically connectable to an external device to be connected to the HDD are mounted.

[0004] With an increase in the capacity of the HDD, the thickness of the housing increases. Accordingly, the area of the side surface of the housing can also be used as a PCB mount surface, and therefore, a flexible design in which the mount surface can be selected according to product specifications is desirable.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0005] FIG. 1 shows a perspective view of an HDD according to a first embodiment.

[0006] FIG. 2 shows a plan view of the HDD according to the first embodiment.

[0007] FIG. 3 shows a perspective view of an I/F connector.

[0008] FIG. 4 shows an X-Z plan view of the HDD according to the first embodiment.

[0009] FIGS. 5 and 6 are each a cross-sectional view of one example of the first embodiment taken along line A-A' in FIG. 4.

[0010] FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view of the first embodiment taken along line B-B' in FIG. 4.

[0011] FIG. 8 shows an X-Z plan view of an HDD according to a second embodiment.

[0012] FIG. 9 shows a cross-sectional view of the second embodiment taken along line B-B' in FIG. 8.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0013] Embodiments provide a disk apparatus, such as an HDD, including a connector disposed on a PCB on a side surface of a housing.

[0014] In general, according to one embodiment, a disk apparatus includes plural magnetic disks, a spindle motor that rotates the plural magnetic disks, and a housing. The housing has a bottom wall to which the spindle motor is attached, and a side wall molded integrally with the bottom wall. Further, the disk apparatus includes a board attached to the side wall and a connector attached to the board. The connector has a housing portion with a first surface at least partially facing the bottom wall and a second surface crossing the first surface and a contact portion provided in contact with at least one of the first surface and the second surface, and the contact portion has one end for electric connection with an external device and the other end on a side of the connector away from the bottom wall.

[0015] Hereinafter, embodiments of the present disclosure will be described with reference to the drawings. In this description, common elements are denoted by common reference signs throughout the drawings. As shown in each drawing, an X axis, a Y axis, and a Z axis are defined for the sake of convenience in the present specification. The X axis, the Y axis, and the Z axis are orthogonal to each other. When an HDD **10** is in a rectangular shape, the X axis is provided along the short side direction of the HDD **10**, and the Y axis is provided along the long side direction of the HDD **10**. The Z axis is provided along the thickness direction of the HDD **10**.

[0016] For the sake of description, a Z direction from a top cover (not shown) to a bottom wall of the HDD **10** will be referred to as “upper” or a “+Z direction”, and the opposite direction thereof will be referred to as “lower” or a “-Z direction”.

[0017] The present embodiments do not limit the scope of the present disclosure and dimensions and ratios in the drawings are not limited to those shown in the drawings.

First Embodiment

[0018] FIG. **1** is a perspective view showing an example of the HDD **10** according to a first embodiment.

[0019] As shown in FIG. **1**, a housing **1** of the HDD **10** is configured such that a bottom wall **11** and side walls **12**, **13** standing in the Z direction from peripheral edge portions of the bottom wall **11** are integrally molded. For the bottom wall **11** and the side walls **12**, **13**, for example, an alloy material such as aluminum is used.

[0020] The side wall **12** is provided to extend in the Y direction along the length of the HDD **10**, and the side wall **13** is provided to extend in the X direction along the width of the HDD **10**.

[0021] A first PCB **60a** which is a mount board is provided on the bottom wall **11** of the housing **1**, and a second PCB **60b** is provided on the side wall **13**.

[0022] Each of the first PCB **60a** and the second PCB **60b** has plural attachment portions **70**, and is fixed to the housing **1** with metal fittings such as screws. An interface (I/F) connector **50** for connecting the HDD to an external device is further mounted on the second PCB **60b** fixed to the side wall **13**.

[0023] The I/F connector **50** is fixed, at both end portions thereof, to the second PCB **60b** and the housing **1** with screws **80**. That is, the HDD **10** is configured such that the second PCB **60b**, the I/F connector **50**, and the housing **1** are provided in this order in the Y direction.

[0024] The I/F connector **50** according to the present embodiment is a connector that conforms to at least one of a serial ATA (SATA) standard or a serial attached SCSI (SAS) standard. The I/F connector **50** may be a connector that conforms to other standards.

[0025] The I/F connector **50** is located in the vicinity of a boundary between the bottom wall **11** and the side wall **13**. That is, the I/F connector **50** is provided at a corner portion of the housing **1** at which the I/F connector **50** and the bottom wall **11** are closest to each other. The I/F connector **50** may be at the location of an I/F connector specified in the SATA standard or the SAS standard.

[0026] A first opening M of the I/F connector **50** faces outward of the side wall **13**. A receptacle connector in which the first opening M is exposed to the outside, such as in the I/F connector **50**, is used in combination with a plug connector to be inserted into the first opening M, such that two types of electric connectors are used in combination.

[0027] The HDD **10** is connected to the external device (not shown), and in this case, the I/F connector **50** is connected to a plug connector mounted on the external device. The plug connector is inserted into and detached from the I/F connector **50** in the length direction (Y direction) of the HDD **10**.

[0028] The HDD **10** of the present embodiment is a 3.5 inch HDD. The thickness T of the HDD **10** according to the present embodiment is greater than 26.1 mm which is the general thickness of the 3.5 inch HDD, and for example, is set to be about 53 mm. The thickness T is not limited to this particular number.

[0029] FIG. **2** is a plan view of the HDD **10** according to the first embodiment. For the sake of

description, the top cover is omitted.

[0030] As shown in FIG. 2, the HDD **10** has an inner chamber S formed by the bottom wall **11** and the side walls **12**, **13**. The inner chamber S houses a magnetic disk **21** that magnetically records information, a spindle motor (SPM) **20**, a carriage assembly **32**, a ramp member **22**, a voice coil motor (VCM) **34**, and a flexible printed circuit (FPC) **40**.

[0031] The SPM **20** is attached to the bottom wall **11**, and functions as a drive motor. The magnetic disk **21** includes plural magnetic disks **21**, and is supported and rotated by the SPM **20**.

[0032] The carriage assembly **32** is supported so as to move relative to the magnetic disk **21**, and is rotated and positioned by the VCM **34**.

[0033] The carriage assembly **32** is provided with a magnetic head **30**, and the magnetic head **30** records information in the magnetic disk **21** and reproduces information from the magnetic disk **21**.

[0034] The ramp member **22** holds the magnetic head **30** at a retreat location apart from the magnetic disk **21** after the magnetic head **30** has moved to the outermost periphery of the magnetic disk **21**.

[0035] The plural magnetic disks **21**, e.g., ten magnetic disks **21**, are provided in the Z direction in the HDD **10**. The magnetic disks **21** are not limited to the ten disks, and may be nine or less or 11 or more.

[0036] The diameter of the magnetic disk **21** is set, for example, to 80 mm or more and 100 mm or less. Specifically, the diameter is set to about 96 mm. The diameter of the magnetic disk **21** is not limited to this example.

[0037] The carriage assembly **32** includes a bearing portion **33**, an arm **35** extending from the bearing portion **33**, and an elastically-deformable elongated plate-shaped suspension **31** fixed to the tip end of the arm **35**.

[0038] The suspension **31** includes a leaf spring, and the base end thereof is fixed to the tip end of the arm **35** by, e.g., spot welding or swaging and extends from the arm **35**. The magnetic head **30** is attached to the suspension **31**.

[0039] When power is supplied to the VCM **34**, the carriage assembly **32** turns with the bearing portion **33** as an axis, and the magnetic head **30** is moved to a desired location on the surface of the magnetic disk **21** and is positioned at such a location. In this manner, the magnetic head **30** can write information in the magnetic disk **21** or read information from the magnetic disk **21**.

[0040] A relay connector (not shown) is mounted on the first PCB **60a** attached to the housing **1**. The relay connector is electrically connected to the SPM **20** and the VCM **34** housed in the inner chamber S, for example, via a connector (not shown) provided on the bottom wall **11**. In this manner, the first PCB **60a** controls operation of the components housed in the inner chamber S. In the present embodiment, the board that controls operation of the components housed in the inner chamber S may be the second PCB **60b**. In this case, the relay connector is mounted, for example, on the second PCB **60b**, and is connected to the inner chamber S via a connector provided on the side wall **13**.

[0041] FIG. 3 is a perspective view of the I/F connector **50** according to the first embodiment.

[0042] The I/F connector **50** includes a housing portion **51** and plural contact portions **52**. The housing portion **51** is made of an insulating material such as resin, and the contact portion **52** is made of a conductive material such as copper.

[0043] The housing portion **51** has the first opening M into which the plug connector of the external device is to be inserted.

[0044] The first opening M is designed, for example, so as not to protrude from a body of the HDD **10**.

[0045] Further, the housing portion **51** has a housing bottom portion **51a** for supporting a plug connector body when the plug connector is fitted in the housing portion **51**.

[0046] Further, the housing portion **51** has a housing extending portion **51b** for maintaining a state of the plug connector being fitted in the housing portion **51** and maintaining an electric connection

state. The housing extending portion **51b** is provided apart from the housing bottom portion **51a** in the Z direction. The plug connector is provided between the housing bottom portion **51a** and the housing extending portion **51b**.

[0047] The housing bottom portion **51a** and the housing extending portion **51b** at least partially face the bottom wall **11**.

[0048] The plural contact portions **52** are arranged in the X direction on the housing extending portion **51b**.

[0049] The contact portion **52** is inserted into and held by a housing back member **51c** which is a butting portion when the plug connector is fitted. That is, the housing back member **51c** is a portion with which the plug connector contacts when the plug connector is inserted deep into the I/F connector **50**. The housing bottom portion **51a** and the housing extending portion **51b** extend from the housing back member **51c** in the-Y direction.

[0050] The housing back member **51c** crosses the housing bottom portion **51a** and the housing extending portion **51b**.

[0051] The contact portion **52** may be press-fitted and fixed to the housing back member **51c**, or may be molded integrally with the housing back member **51c** by insert molding.

[0052] At both end portions of the I/F connector **50**, two attachment portions **53** for fixing the I/F connector **50** with screws are provided. Attachment metal fittings such as the screws **80** are inserted into the attachment portions **53**, and are also inserted into attachment holes provided in the second PCB **60b** and the housing **1**.

[0053] FIG. **4** is an X-Z plan view of the HDD **10** according to the first embodiment. FIG. **4** shows a state in which the second PCB **60b** on which the I/F connector **50** is mounted is attached to the body of the HDD **10** with the screws **80**.

[0054] In order to comply with the standard of the HDD, a first recess **300** for housing the I/F connector **50** is provided in the housing **1** such that the I/F connector **50** does not protrude from the housing **1** of the HDD **10**. The first recess **300** has, for example, a shape corresponding to the outer shape of the I/F connector **50**. Part of the side wall **13** forming the first recess **300** supports, for example, both end portions of the I/F connector **50**.

[0055] Further, a second recess **301** is formed at a location at which the external device side plug connector is to be inserted, in the second PCB **60b**.

[0056] The attachment portions **53** are located between the second PCB **60b** and the side wall **13** of the housing **1**, and in FIG. **4**, are not visually recognized. On the other hand, the first opening M is visually recognizable through the second recess **301**.

[0057] FIG. **5** is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A' in FIG. **4**, and shows an electric connection state between the I/F connector **50** and the second PCB **60b**.

[0058] In FIG. **5**, the second PCB **60b** has a first PCB surface **91** facing the side wall **13** and a second PCB surface **92** which is a surface opposite to the first PCB surface **91**, and the I/F connector **50** is mounted on the first PCB surface **91**.

[0059] As shown in FIG. **5**, the housing bottom portion **51a** has a curved outer surface shape R.

[0060] According to FIG. **5**, the contact portion **52** inserted into the housing back member **51c** has one end and the other end. The one end of the contact portion **52** has a first connection portion **200** for electric connection with the plug connector at the housing extending portion **51b**. The first connection portion **200** is indicated by a dashed line.

[0061] The contact portion **52** has a fixed portion **201** fixed by the housing back member **51c**. The contact portion **52** is orthogonal to a connector insertion direction in a region adjacent to the fixed portion **201**, and is bent in a direction (-Z direction) apart from the bottom wall **11** of the HDD. The fixed portion **201** is indicated by a dash-dotted line.

[0062] The bent contact portion **52** has a curved portion **203** bent along the outer surface shape R of the housing portion **51**. That is, the curved portion **203** has a curvature greater than zero. The other end of the contact portion **52** is electrically connected to the first PCB surface **91** immediately

below the housing bottom portion **51a** by a joining member such as solder. Here, immediately below the housing bottom portion **51a** indicates an adjacent region extending in the $-Z$ direction from the lowermost surface of the housing bottom portion **51a**. For example, immediately below the housing bottom portion **51a** indicates a region within one centimeter in the $-Z$ direction from the lowermost surface of the housing bottom portion **51a**. A region of the contact portion **52** connected to the second PCB **60b** is a second connection portion **202**, and is indicated by a dashed line. That is, the other end of the contact portion **52** has the second connection portion **202**. The contact portion **52** is configured such that the first connection portion **200** (one end), the fixed portion **201**, the curved portion **203**, and the second connection portion **202** (other end) are provided in this order and are integrally formed.

[0063] The contact portion **52** may have a bent portion **204** bent in a stepwise manner between the curved portion **203** and the second connection portion **202** such that the second connection portion **202** contacts the first PCB surface **91**.

[0064] Depending on the type of signal, the first connection portion **200** includes one not held by the housing extending portion **51b**.

[0065] The curved portion **203** of the contact portion **52** may include, for example, one mechanically having spring properties, and one simply bent in a stepwise manner.

[0066] The contact portion **52** may be bent in contact with the housing portion **51** along the outer surface shape **R** of the housing portion **51**.

[0067] As shown in FIG. **6**, the contact portion **52** may be at least partially apart from the outer surface of the I/F connector **50** between the fixed portion **201** and the second connection portion **202**.

[0068] An electrode pad (not shown) to be connected to the second connection portion **202** is disposed on the first PCB surface **91**, and is electrically connected using a joining member such as solder. The electrode pad corresponds to each of the plural contact portions **52**. The electric connection method is not limited to soldering, and for example, laser or welding may be used.

[0069] FIG. **7** is a cross-sectional view taken along B-B' line in FIG. **4**, and shows a state of the I/F connector **50** being attached to the body of the HDD **10**.

[0070] According to FIG. **7**, the second PCB **60b** is provided with attachment portions **54**, and the housing **1** is provided with attachment portions **55**. The common attachment metal fittings such as the screws **80** are inserted into the attachment portions **53** provided at both ends of the I/F connector **50** and the attachment portions **54** provided at the second PCB **60b**, and are fixed to the attachment portions **55** provided at the housing **1**.

Effects of First Embodiment

[0071] Effects of the HDD **10** according to the first embodiment will be described.

[0072] In an HDD of the related art, an I/F connector **50** for connection with an external device is mounted on a first PCB **60a** mounted on a bottom wall **11**, and no PCB is attached to a side wall **13**.

[0073] The second PCB **60b** is provided on the side wall **13** and the I/F connector **50** is mounted thereon as in the present embodiment, so that a PCB mount region can be expanded and an increase in the number of electronic components and an increase in the number of magnetic disks resulting from future HDD performance improvement can be handled.

[0074] For example, when the power consumption of the SPM or the VCM has increased due to HDD performance improvement, the number of multi-layer ceramic capacitors (MLCCs) or tantalum capacitors increases.

[0075] When such a component having a great height after mounting is mounted on the first PCB **60a** so as to face the bottom wall **11**, a space for mounting the component needs to be provided inside the HDD. For this reason, a space in the thickness direction (Z direction) of the HDD **10** is narrowed, which limits the mount height of the magnetic disk and interferes with an increase in the number of magnetic disks.

[0076] On the other hand, when the component having a great height after mounting is mounted on the second PCB **60b**, a space in the longitudinal direction (Y direction) of the HDD is narrowed due to securing a space for mounting the component. In this case, the mount height of the magnetic disk is not limited, which does not interfere with an increase in the number of magnetic disks.

[0077] In many cases, such a component having a great mount height is mounted on the same board as that for the I/F connector **50** influencing the power consumption.

[0078] For this reason, the I/F connector **50** is mounted on the second PCB **60b** so that a region for mounting the component having a great mount height can be expanded and a design that is advantageous in increasing the number of magnetic disks can be achieved.

[0079] In a case where the HDD is connected to the external device such as a server, a cooling system is mounted, which leads to a concern about transmission of vibration due to an air-cooling fan to the HDD body.

[0080] In the present embodiment, the contact portion **52** has the curved portion **203** or the bent portion **204**, and therefore, stress due to the vibration from the server can be absorbed and an effect of avoiding partial stress concentration and an effect of preventing resonance in vibration with a specific frequency can be expected.

[0081] Such server vibration leads to a concern about degradation of the function of the HDD body and shortening of the lifetime of the soldered portion, and for this reason, reduction in the vibration also leads to extension of the lifetime of the HDD body.

[0082] Further, it can be expected that the curved portion **203** of the contact portion **52** provides an effect of absorbing distortion when the second PCB **60b** and the I/F connector **50** are attached to the HDD body and reducing a load on the soldered portion.

[0083] In FIG. **6**, the curved portion **203** of the contact portion **52** has a structure of being at least partially apart from the outer surface of the I/F connector **50**. Since the curved portion **203** is apart from the I/F connector **50** in the vicinity of the soldered portion of the contact portion **52**, the above-described effects are more easily obtainable.

[0084] For example, it may be configured such that the contact portion **52** and a partial surface of the housing bottom portion **51a** facing the bottom wall does not contact each other. With this configuration, the entire length of the contact portion **52** is increased, which is effective in absorbing the stress due to the vibration.

Second Embodiment

[0085] Hereinafter, a second embodiment will be described with reference to FIG. **8**. In the following description of plural embodiments, elements having functions similar to those of the elements already described are denoted by the same reference signs as those of the already-described elements and description thereof may be omitted.

[0086] FIG. **8** is an X-Z plan view of the HDD **10** according to the second embodiment.

[0087] The second embodiment is different from the first embodiment in that the attachment portions **53** of the I/F connector **50** are fixed to the housing **1** without also being attached to the second PCB **60b**.

[0088] In the second embodiment, the second PCB **60b** has the attachment portions **70**, and is fixed to the housing **1**.

[0089] The state of connection between the I/F connector **50** and the second PCB **60b** is similar to that in the first embodiment, and therefore, FIG. **5** is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A' in FIG. **8**.

[0090] FIG. **9** is a cross-sectional view taken along line B-B' in FIG. **8**, and shows a state of the I/F connector **50** being attached to the HDD body.

[0091] According to FIG. **9**, the I/F connector **50** is not fixed to the HDD **10** with the screws causing the second PCB **60b** to press the I/F connector **50** against the HDD **10**, but is directly fixed to the HDD **10** with the screws.

Effects of Second Embodiment

[0092] Effects of the HDD **10** according to the second embodiment will be described. expected.
[0093] In the present embodiment, effects similar to those in the first embodiment can be
[0094] As compared to the first embodiment, the vibration of the external device is less likely to be directly transmitted to the second PCB **60b** via the I/F connector **50**. That is, the vibration of the external device received by the I/F connector **50** is directly absorbed by the curved portion **203** or the bent portion **204** of the contact portion **52**. The HDD **10** according to the second embodiment can absorb the stress due to the vibration from the external device, and an effect of avoiding partial stress concentration and an effect of preventing resonance in vibration with a specific frequency can be expected.

[0095] While certain embodiments have been described, these embodiments have been presented by way of example only, and are not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure. Indeed, the novel embodiments described herein may be embodied in a variety of other forms; furthermore, various omissions, substitutions, and changes in the form of the embodiments described herein may be made without departing from the spirit of the disclosure. The accompanying claims and their equivalents are intended to cover such forms or modifications as would fall within the scope and spirit of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A disk apparatus comprising: plural magnetic disks; a spindle motor that rotates the plural magnetic disks; a housing having a bottom wall to which the spindle motor is attached, and a side wall molded integrally with the bottom wall; a board attached to the side wall; and a connector attached to the board, wherein the connector has a housing portion having a first surface at least partially facing the bottom wall and a second surface crossing the first surface, and a contact portion provided in contact with at least one of the first surface or the second surface, and the contact portion has a first end for electric connection with an external device, and a second end provided on a side of the connector away from the bottom wall.
2. The disk apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the connector is a connector that conforms with at least one of a SAS standard and a SATA standard.
3. The disk apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the contact portion further has a curved portion between the first end and the second end.
4. The disk apparatus according to claim 3, wherein the contact portion further has a bent portion between the curved portion and the second end.
5. The disk apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the board has a third surface facing the side wall, and the connector is electrically connected to the third surface with solder.
6. The disk apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the board is provided with a first recess in which the connector is disposed.
7. The disk apparatus according to claim 1, wherein each longitudinal end of the connector has an attachment portion into which a screw is to be inserted.
8. The disk apparatus according to claim 7, wherein the attachment portion is located between the board and the housing.
9. The disk apparatus according to claim 8, wherein a screw is inserted into the attachment portion and the board, and is fixed to the housing.
10. The disk apparatus according to claim 7, wherein the connector is directly fixed to the housing with the screw inserted into the attachment portion.
11. A disk apparatus comprising: plural magnetic disks; a spindle motor that rotates the plural magnetic disks; a housing having a bottom wall to which the spindle motor is attached, and a side wall extending in a first direction from the bottom wall; a printed circuit board (PCB) attached to the side wall; and a connector having a body with a first surface at least partially facing the bottom wall and a second surface crossing the first surface, and a contact portion, wherein the contact

portion has a first end for electric connection with an external device, and a second end spaced away from the body of the connector in the first direction away from the bottom wall and electrically connected to the PCB.

12. The disk apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the connector conforms with at least one of a SAS standard and a SATA standard.

13. The disk apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the contact portion further has a curved portion between the first end and the second end.

14. The disk apparatus according to claim 13, wherein the contact portion further has a bent portion between the curved portion and the second end.

15. The disk apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the PCB has a third surface facing the side wall, and the connector is electrically connected to the third surface with solder.

16. The disk apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the PCB is provided with a first recess in which the connector is disposed.

17. The disk apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the connector extends in a second direction parallel to a surface of the side wall and perpendicular to the first direction and has an attachment portion into which a screw is to be inserted, at each end thereof in the second direction.

18. The disk apparatus according to claim 17, wherein the attachment portion is located between the PCB and the housing.

19. The disk apparatus according to claim 18, wherein a screw is inserted into the attachment portion and the PCB, and is fixed to the housing.

20. The disk apparatus according to claim 17, wherein the connector is directly fixed to the housing with the screw inserted into the attachment portion.
